

FAMILY CAREGIVER HANDBOOK

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Supporting Your Loved One in Residential Care

Introduction

This handbook provides guidance for families supporting a loved one in residential care. Your involvement is essential to their quality of life and wellbeing.

Staying Actively Involved

Regular Visits and Communication:

- Schedule regular visits that work for both you and your loved one
- Maintain phone calls or video chats between visits
- Involve them in family decisions and important updates
- Share family photos and news
- Participate in community events together

Activities Together:

- Enjoying meals and outings
- Participating in community activities
- Pursuing shared hobbies and interests
- Taking walks or spending time outdoors
- Celebrating special occasions and milestones

Advocating for Your Loved One

- Communicate needs and preferences to the care team
- Review care plans and wellness goals regularly
- Ask questions about medications and treatments
- Voice concerns promptly and professionally
- Work collaboratively with staff for best outcomes

Building Relationships with Care Staff

- Introduce yourself and build positive rapport
- Express appreciation for care provided
- Share relevant health history and preferences
- Understand staff schedules and communication channels
- Participate in care planning discussions

Maintaining Their Identity

- Support participation in hobbies and interests
- Help maintain spiritual or religious practices
- Celebrate cultural traditions
- Keep them connected to their community
- Encourage meaningful activities

Taking Care of Yourself

- Maintain your own health and wellbeing
- Set healthy boundaries

- Seek support from family members or counseling
- Don't hesitate to ask for help when needed
- Remember that self-care is essential

Communication Tips

- Be respectful and professional with staff
- Address concerns calmly and directly
- Listen to professional recommendations
- Share observations about your loved one
- Work as a team for the best outcomes

When to Speak Up

Contact the care team or management if:

- Your loved one seems unhappy or unwell
- Concerns about care quality arise
- You have questions about medications or treatments
- You're overwhelmed or struggling emotionally

Resources

Our care team is available to answer questions and support your family. Don't hesitate to reach out with concerns or suggestions.